TECHNO-OPTIMISM

Embracing AI in Education

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Brief Background

From creating research reports to assisting academic tasks, AI has become an increasingly useful tool in education due to its instant nature. The growing integration of AI reflects a techno-optimistic belief that technology can improve educational experiences. However, without sufficient preparation, excessive optimism may gradually normalize AI dependence.

Aims & Objectives

- Gain the General Understanding of AI among Educators & Learners
- Explore AI use in the Academic Setting
- Understand diverse Evaluations of AI use in School
- View Expectations of Future AI Use in academic setting

Methods

1. Explore
Perspectives and experiences of individuals use of AI

2. Select
2 teachers and 4 students (done by the school)

3. Prepare
Question guidelines & Informed consent for a semistructured interview

4. Conduct
Offline interviews in school for 30-50 minutes

5. Analyze
Similarities, Differences & Relevances in data

Main Findings

The school implemented technology incrementally. Starting with the provision of chrombeooks in 2024, and later on in mandatory coding class, which involves AI more intensely. Common uses included:

- Information Searching
- Lesson Planning
- Summarizing
- Assignment Creation

Conclusion Recommendation

S ***trategic thinking*** (Drmola & Kraus, 2023; Santrock, 2006)
Plan ahead and establish goals before using AI to be more purposeful when using the tool.

H ***one critical thinking***
Direct experience of using AI with supervision. Encourage critical argumentation in class.
(Santrock, 2006; Dessingué & Wagner, 2025)

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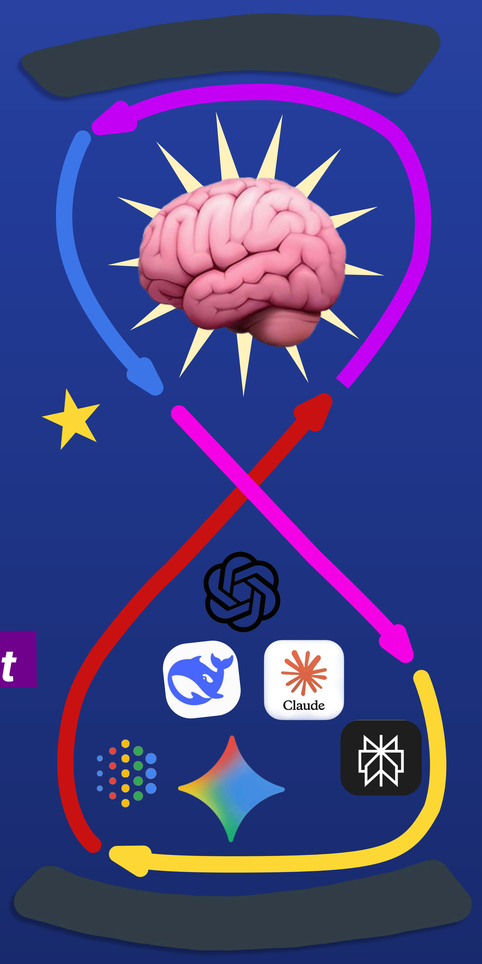
N ***urture a Mastery-Oriented mindset***
Emphasize the importance of learning process through engaging & exciting class environment.
(Santrock, 2006; Schiefele, 2017)

E ***ncourage Intrinsic Motivation***
Intrinsic motivation foster ideal standards of using AI. (Santrock, 2006)



Bibliography

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Analysis

Techno-Optimism

Believing technological developments generally improves quality of life, while potentially leading to overreliance on technological solutions. This is evident in the way the school actively promotes Chromebooks and coding courses.

Cognitive Dissonance

Individuals experience tension between their concerns about AI and their continued reliance on it because of its convenience and efficiency. (Zheng & Wang, 2026; Ren et al., 2026).

Cognitive Offloading

The tendency to let tools do part of the thinking. participants frequently use AI to "offload" cognitive tasks, thereby mental processes are left untrained. (Risko & Gilbert, 2016).

Lack of Consensus regarding AI use

Minimal structured guidelines result in varying perspectives of how AI should be utilized. Since guidelines for AI use have not yet been formalized there may be risks of normalizing AI use which could ultimately lead to the phenomenon of AI dependency. (Danaher, 2022; Meivawati 2026)

Consequences?

- School-Based AI Platforms and standardized AI tools
- Lack of evaluation when receive AI-based Information
- Increased reliance on AI and decline in critical learning skills